

Activity 4 - Build the Risk Register and Fund the Right Responses

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 4 | Manage Project Risk
 Learning outcome: LO4 Duration: 75 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Risk Matrix, Decision Tree and Tornado templates

Objective

Identify risks to project success and take proportionate action (A4, K4).

The situation

The pilot has entered build. The POS interface may be delivered late, refrigerated stock counts are unreliable at one outlet, a key trainer is available for only two weeks, and a faster payment option could improve adoption but costs more. The remaining contingency reserve is S\$18,000.

What you will do

Write cause-event-impact risk statements, score and rank exposure, assign owners and triggers, choose responses, compare alternatives by expected monetary value and allocate the limited contingency reserve.

What you will produce

A prioritised risk register with owners, triggers, responses, contingency and residual exposure; one decision-tree recommendation; one tornado sensitivity reading; and a reconciled S\$18,000 reserve plan.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/48 Risk Assessment Matrix Two pages.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/45 Decision Tree Analysis TDIDT.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/49 Tornado Chart - Sensitivity Analysis.xlsx`](#)

Data files

- [`data/risk-input.csv`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Open the risk matrix template and enter at least eight risks using the form: because of cause, event may occur, leading to impact.
2. Separate risks from current issues. Move anything already occurring into the issue log and give it an action owner.
3. Score probability and impact using the template scale. Calculate exposure and justify the top three priorities.
4. Assign one risk owner and one response owner. Define an observable trigger for each top risk.
5. Choose avoid, mitigate, transfer, accept or escalate for threats; use exploit, enhance, share, accept or escalate for opportunities.
6. Specify preventive action, contingency action and fallback for the POS-interface risk. State when each activates.

7. Open the decision-tree template. Compare the standard payment option with the faster premium option using the supplied probabilities, costs and benefits.
8. Calculate expected monetary value and recommend an option. Then state one qualitative factor EMV does not capture.
9. Open the tornado template and vary adoption, order volume, vendor delay and training productivity. Identify the two most sensitive assumptions.
10. Allocate the S\$18,000 contingency reserve to named risks. Do not consume management reserve or hide general padding inside activities.
11. Conduct a risk review: close obsolete risks, update exposure, promote triggered risks to issues and record new secondary risks created by responses.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

Every priority risk has cause-event-impact wording, an owner, trigger, funded response and residual score; the decision-tree arithmetic reconciles; and the named contingency allocations total no more than S\$18,000.

Debrief

- An owner does not prevent a risk; they watch the trigger and ensure the agreed response is ready.
- Contingency is not generic padding-it is a funded response to identified uncertainty.
- Quantitative tools sharpen a decision but do not replace judgement about reputation, safety or compliance.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 4. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.